

PRODUCT CASE STUDY

Uber Gifts

Instant Joy, Delivered.

A product case study exploring how Uber can own the instant gifting moment
- leveraging its delivery infrastructure to solve a problem no one has cracked.

Gifting on Impulse Is Broken

You remember a friend's birthday at 6pm. You open an app. It's either fast-but-generic, or beautiful-but-takes-3-days. Nobody has solved both.



Persona 1: Working Professional

Busy · Tech-savvy · Impulse gifter · Won't plan ahead

- ✗ No instant delivery option for physical gifts
- ✗ Limited gift selection on fast-delivery apps
- ✗ No personalisation - gifts feel transactional
- ✗ Poor tracking and accountability
- ✗ Low trust in niche gifting platforms



Persona 2: Special Occasion User

Selective · Values personalisation · Festival-driven

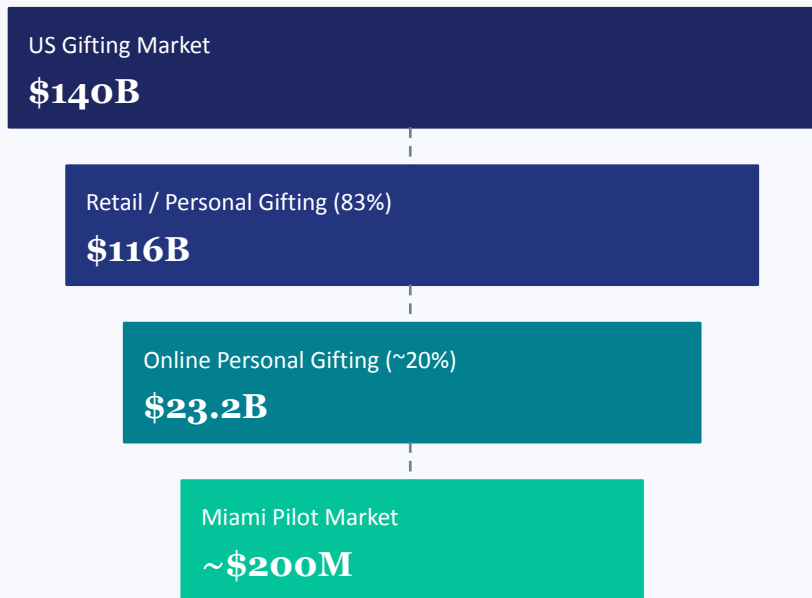
- ✗ High delivery costs on personalised platforms
- ✗ Minimum 6-hour booking window - no spontaneity
- ✗ Limited customisation options
- ✗ No delivery tracking on gifting apps
- ✗ Security concerns with lesser-known platforms

Core tension: Speed vs Selection. The faster the delivery, the worse the gift options. No platform has solved both - yet.

MARKET OPPORTUNITY

A \$23B Market With Wind at Its Back - and Uber Already Has the Engine

Bottom-Up Market Sizing



3 Tailwinds Driving Growth



Online gifting CAGR ~11%

Growing 3× faster than physical retail gifting - digital-first behaviour is permanent post-COVID.



Rising disposable income

Millennials and Gen-Z spending more on experiences and gifting for micro-occasions.



Habit shift post-COVID

Remote gifting normalised. Consumers now expect to send gifts without being present.



Uber's unfair advantage: 34% US market share on Uber Eats + existing delivery fleet = zero infrastructure cost to pilot.

Three Categories of Players. One Unsolved Gap.

Instant Gifting

DoorDash · Sugarwish

Pain points

- ✗ Only food items, gift cards, digital gifts
- ✗ No physical gift options
- ✗ No personalisation
- ✗ Low brand association with gifting

Personalised Gifting

Etsy · Shutterfly · Personal Creations

Pain points

- ✗ Minimum 6-hour window — no spontaneity
- ✗ High delivery cost
- ✗ Poor real-time tracking
- ✗ No customer support SLA

Gift Marketplaces

Amazon · Walmart · eBay

Pain points

- ✗ Not associated with gifting in users' minds
- ✗ No personalisation layer
- ✗ 2–5 day delivery standard
- ✗ Speed vs selection trade-off unresolved

The gap: No player offers instant delivery + broad selection + personalisation. That's the white space Uber Gifts targets.

What Nobody Has Built - Yet

Three gaps big enough for Uber to own.

01

Instant + Broad Selection

The Problem

Fast delivery apps have no physical gifts. Gift platforms take days.

Uber's Solution

Partner with Etsy and curated merchants to surface a wide gift catalogue with Uber Eats' same-day delivery.

02

Personalisation at Speed

The Problem

Personalised gifts require 6+ hour lead time. Impulse moments are lost.

Uber's Solution

Add a personalised note to any order - simple, fast, meaningful - without adding delivery time.

03

Responsible Gifting

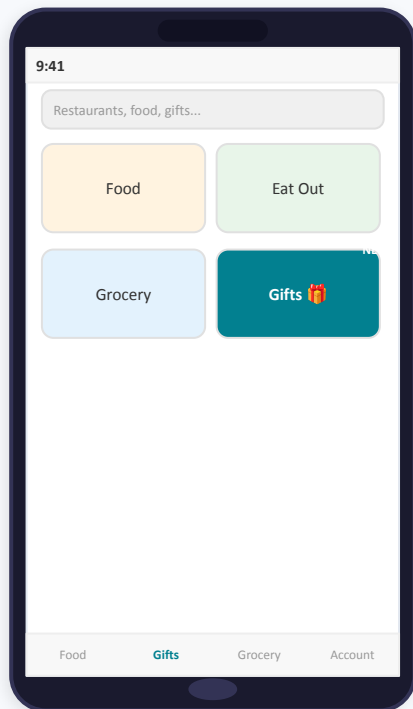
The Problem

No major gifting platform offers eco-conscious or cause-driven gifts.

Uber's Solution

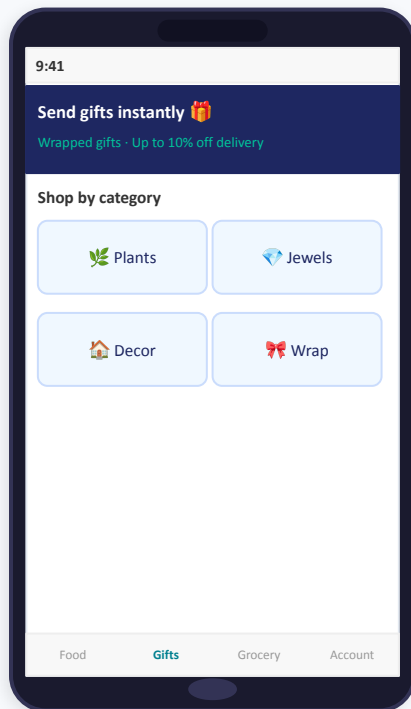
Introduce a 'Green Gifts' category - plants, sustainable goods - for users who want gifts that mean something.

The User Journey - From Discovery to Checkout



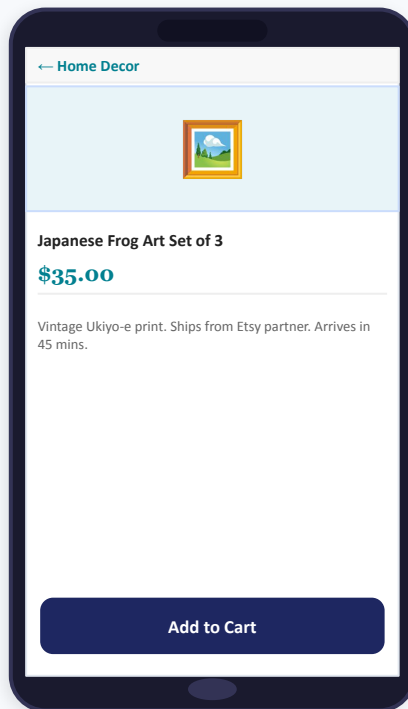
1. Discovery

Uber Eats home - Gifts tab + search hint



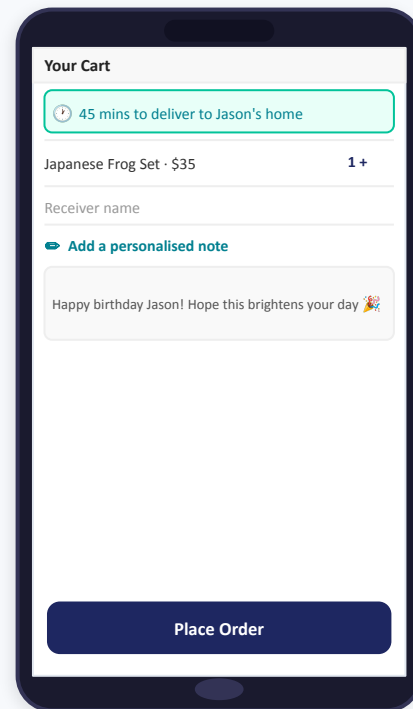
2. Browse

Uber Gifts home - categories + banner



3. Item Detail

Product page - info pulled from partner



4. Checkout

Cart - delivery time + personalised note

How We Know It's Working - and What We are Accepting

Phase 1 · 0–3 Months: Adoption & Activation

- Discoverability: % users who found Uber Gifts
- Usability: % who completed ≥ 1 action
- NPS: % likely to recommend

Phase 2 · 3–6 Months: Retention & Engagement

- Retention: % returning users at 1, 2, 3 months
- MAU growth month-on-month
- Engagement: avg products viewed / session

Honest Trade-offs



App complexity increases

Adding a new service means a heavier UI and longer load times. Mitigated by clear separation of experiences on the home screen.



Delivery fleet strain

Existing drivers will handle gifts alongside food. Average delivery time may increase marginally during peak seasons.



Discovery friction

First-time users will spend extra time finding the Gifts section. 'NEW' badge and search hints reduce this.